

- Trusted family contacts and friends.
- Family reputation (the family brand as understood by outsiders).
- Financial resources.

## **Family Hobbies**

Any hobbies that can be passed on from generation to generation are an opportunity to express your family's identity. Shared hobbies can strengthen family bonds and create opportunities for family to get together.

One thing my family likes to do is get together on weekends and holidays and do simple construction and other manual labor on the family properties. Your authors renovated two chateaux in France, learning how to do stone masonry, among other things. In Argentina, we built a solar-heated adobe house with vaulted ceilings and a dome roof. In Maryland, we built another house, using construction techniques that were novel and, ultimately, a little stupid. But those building experiments continue, and they are part of family lore.

## **Education**

The type of education your family gets says a lot about your view of the world. What sort of schools do members of your family go to? Ivy League universities? Big state universities with big athletic teams? Small liberal arts colleges? International schools?

Is there a local elementary school that your family members have always gone to? Do people in your family take a year off to do some sort of activity before going college?

Your younger author studied the classics at a small liberal arts school called St. John's College in Santa Fe. His brother went to the same college.

Some members of the second generation were home-schooled in middle school. They also followed a classical education program similar to St. John's. An education based on the great books of Western civilization is a part of our family's family culture.

Does your family have an alma mater that multiple family members have attended? Are there certain fields of study that members of your family